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Wachter

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(54) **FISHING POLE HOLDER WITH AUGER TIP**

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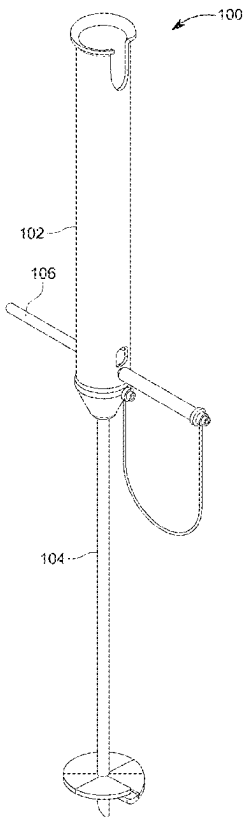
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A01K 97/10 (2006.01)
(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC **A01K 97/10** (2013.01)
(58) **Field of Classification Search**
CPC A01K 97/10; A45F 3/44; E04H 12/2223; E02D 5/801; A45B 2023/0012
See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**
A device for holding a fishing rod or fishing pole includes a holder tube. The holder tube includes a body defining a cavity for receiving one end of the fishing pole or fishing rod, and an opening in the body at a proximal end of the holder tube. The device also includes an auger coupled to a distal end of the holder tube. The auger includes an auger bar and an auger plate. The auger plate is configured to assist with securing the auger in a surface in response to rotating the auger. The device further includes a handle removably coupled to the holder tube and the auger. The handle extends from opposing sides of the pole holder perpendicular to a long axis of the holder tube.

13 Claims, 6 Drawing Sheets



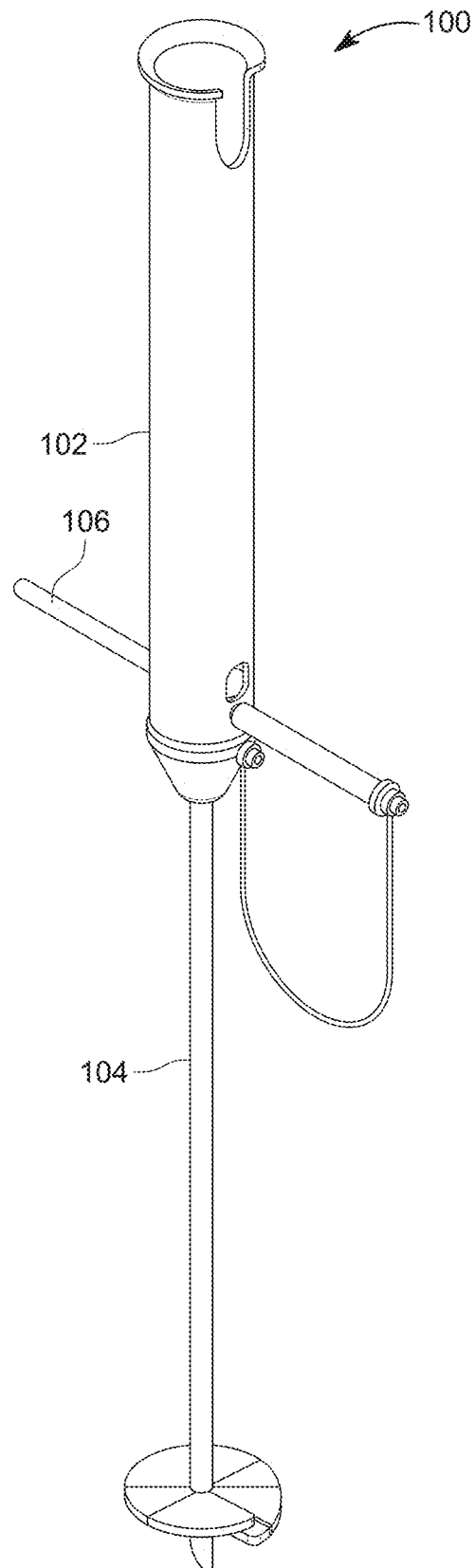


FIG. 1

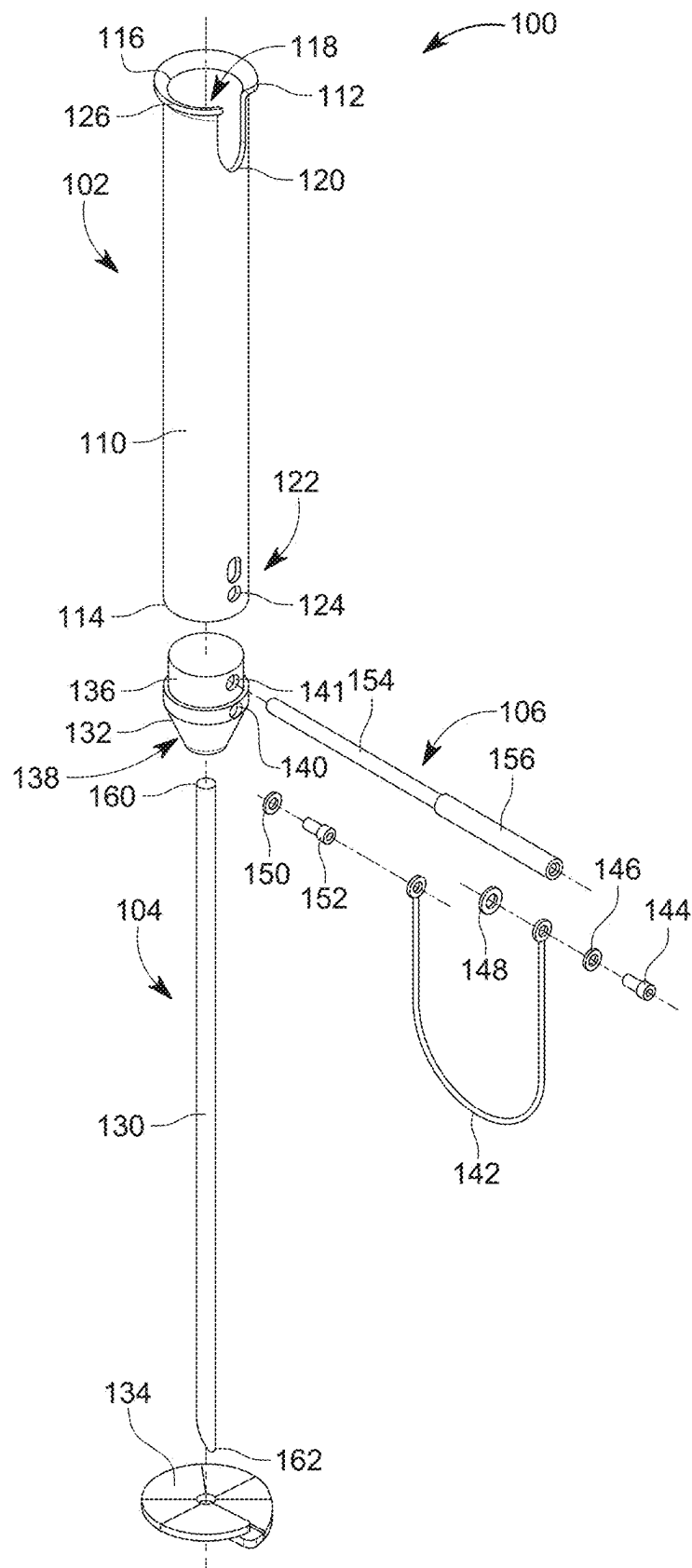


FIG. 2

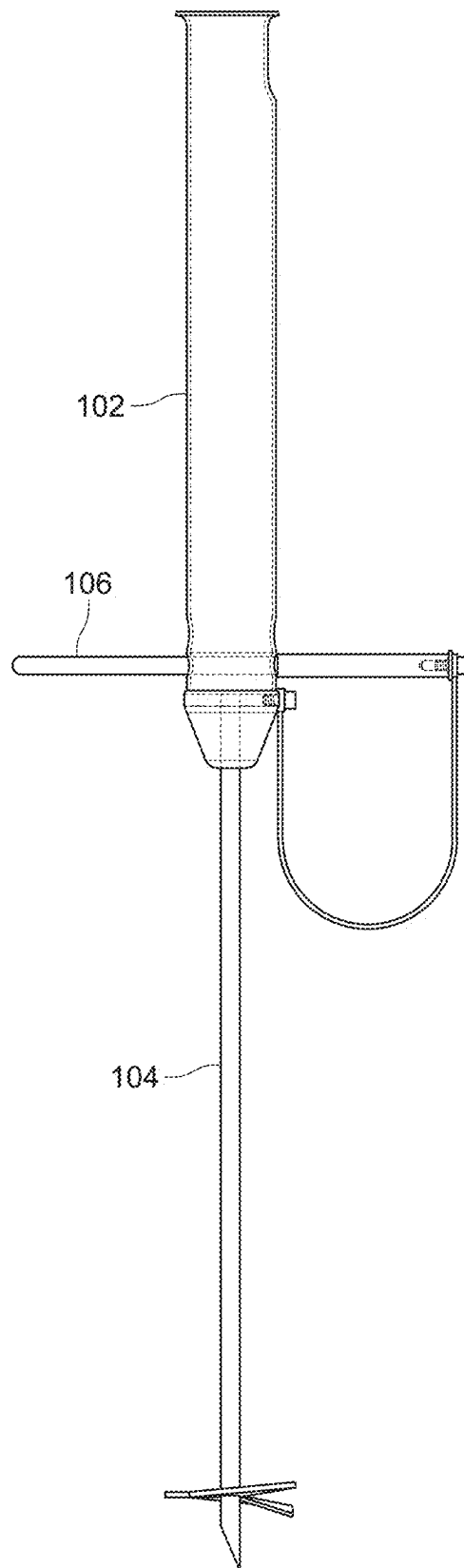


FIG. 3

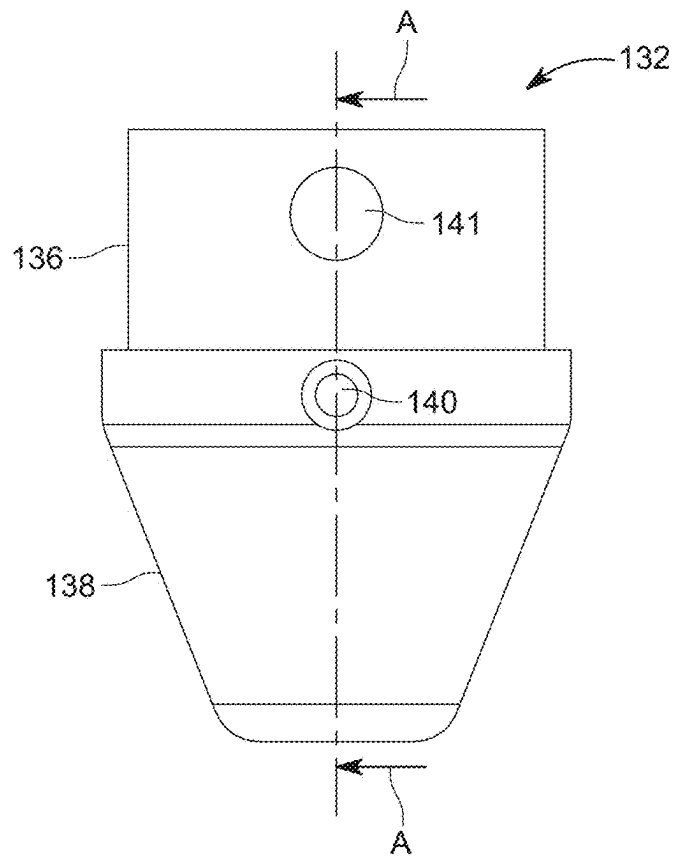
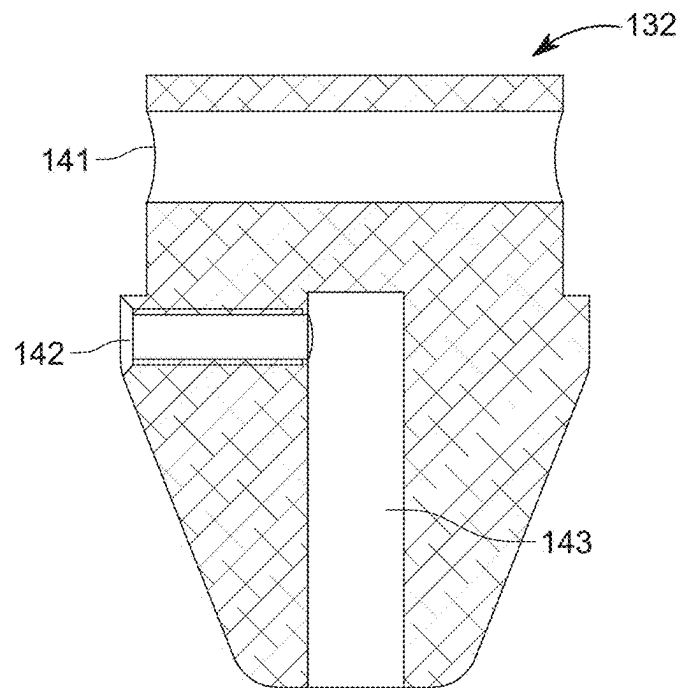


FIG. 4A



SECTION A-A

FIG. 4B

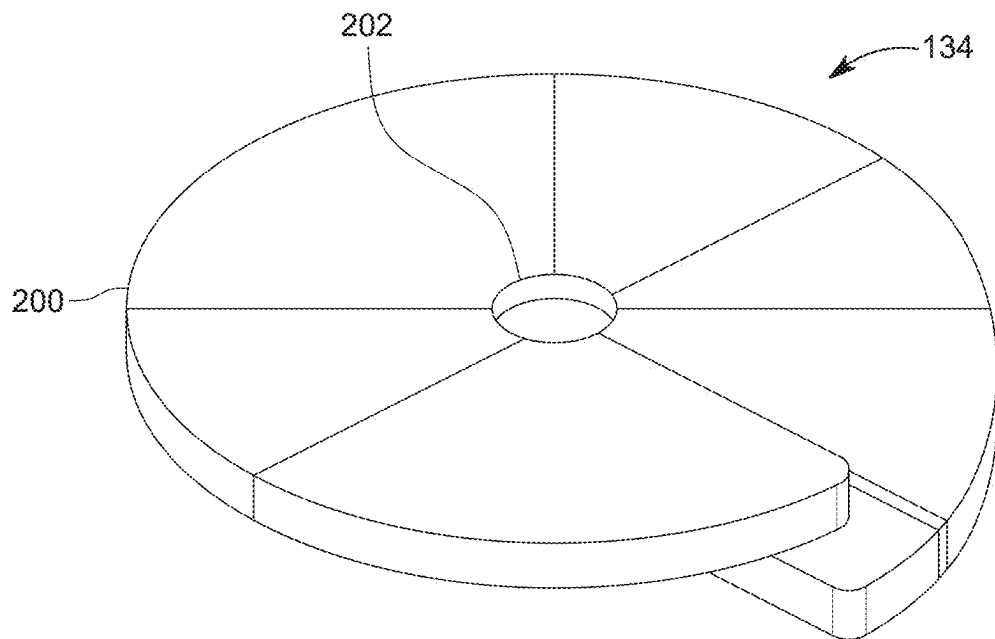


FIG. 5A

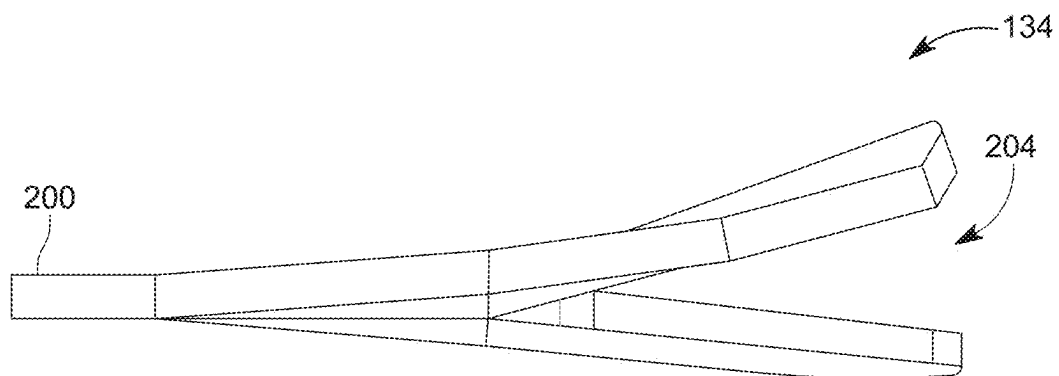


FIG. 5B

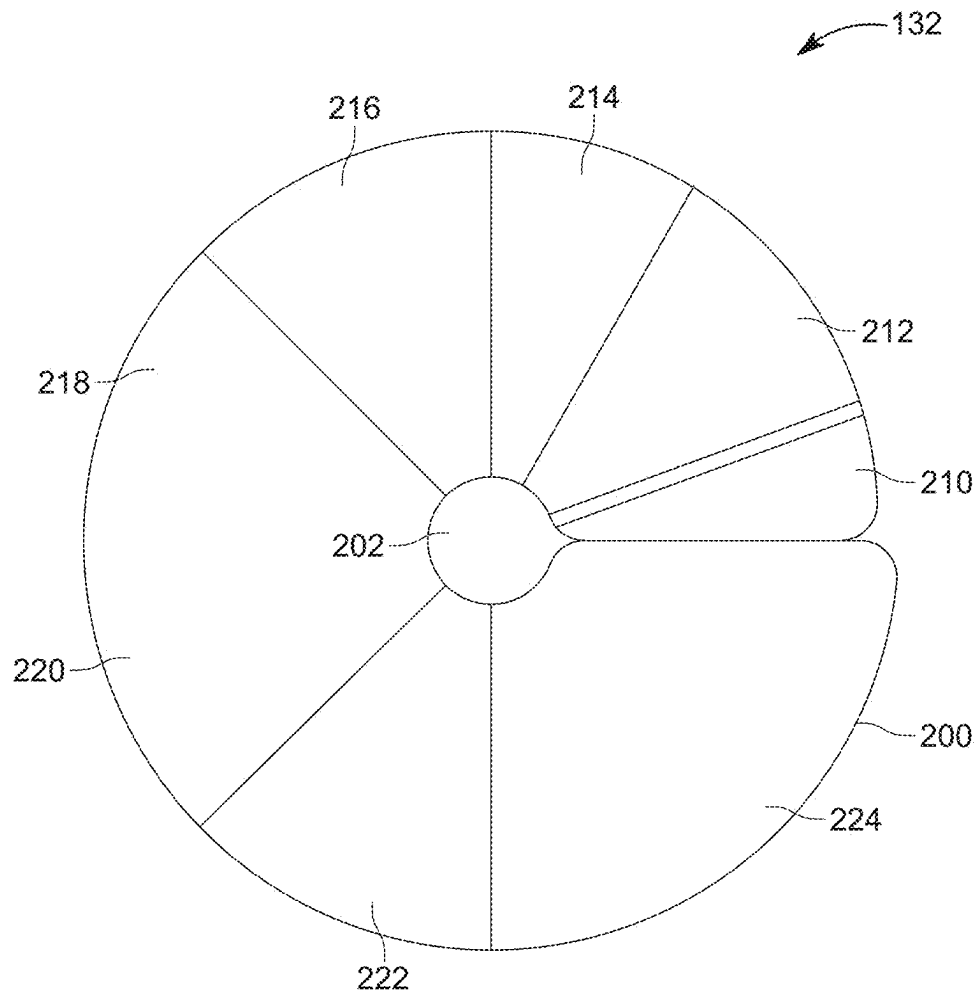


FIG. 5C

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FISHING POLE HOLDER WITH AUGER TIP**CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS**

This application claims the benefit of priority of U.S. provisional application No. 63/466,422, filed May 15, 2023, title, "Sand spike with auger tip for surf fishing," the entire contents of which are herein incorporated by reference.

FIELD

The present disclosure relates to holding devices and, more particularly, to fishing rod and/or pole holders.

BACKGROUND

Sand spike fishing rod holders are driven into the sand at the beach when fishing from the shore, for example, using live bait. They are notoriously difficult to drive into the compacted sand. If the sand spike is not secure, it will fail to hold the rod when a fish takes the bait.

As can be seen, there is a need for fishing rod and/or fishing pole holder that addresses the above drawbacks.

SUMMARY

In one aspect of the present disclosure, a device for holding a fishing rod or fishing pole includes a holder tube. The holder tube includes a body defining a cavity for receiving one end of the fishing pole or fishing rod, and an opening in the body at a proximal end of the holder tube. The device also includes an auger coupled to a distal end of the holder tube. The auger includes an auger bar and an auger plate. The auger plate is configured to assist with securing the auger in a surface in response to rotating the auger. The device further includes a handle removably coupled to the holder tube and the auger. The handle extends from opposing sides of the pole holder perpendicular to a long axis of the holder tube.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

FIG. 1 is a front perspective view of a pole holder, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

FIG. 2 is an exploded view of the pole holder of FIG. 1, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

FIG. 3 is a front elevation view of the pole holder of FIG. 1, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

FIG. 4A is a side elevation view of a connection device of the pole holder of FIG. 1, according to aspects of the present disclosure;

FIG. 4B is a cross-sectional view of the connection device of FIG. 4A; according to aspects of the present disclosure; and

FIGS. 5A-5C are various view of an auger tip for an auger system of the pole holder of FIG. 1, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DISCLOSURE

The following detailed description is of the best currently contemplated modes of carrying out exemplary embodiments of the disclosure. The description is not to be taken in a limiting sense but is made merely for the purpose of

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illustrating the general principles of the disclosure, since the scope of the disclosure is best defined by the appended claims.

As discussed above, sand spike fishing rod holders are driven into the sand at the beach when fishing from the shore. The rod holder typically consists of a rod holder with a rod (sand spike) attached to the holder. The rod is driven directly into the ground, which can be difficult for example, when the sand is compacted sand. Moreover, if the rod is not secure, the rod holder will be pulled from the sand when a fish takes the bait. Some rod holders have attempted to solve this problem by using foot pedals, allowing the user to use the force of his or her legs. This rod holder, however, provides no mechanical advantage with the user providing all the work necessary to drive the rod into the ground.

Broadly, an embodiment of the present disclosure provides a fishing rod or fishing pole holder system ("holder system") that provides for easy installation in the ground, e.g., sand. The holder comprises a holder tube, an auger, and a handle, e.g., T-handle. The auger includes an auger tip that assists with driving the holder system into the ground, e.g., sand. The T-handle allows the holder system to be twisted, thereby causing the auger tip to "bite" into the material of the ground. The holder system can be securely anchored into the sand with a few easy twists.

Referring now to FIGS. 1-3, 4A, 4B, and 5A-5C, FIG. 1 illustrates a fishing rod or fishing pole holder system ("holder system 100") that provides for easy installation in the ground, according to aspects of the present disclosure. While FIG. 1 illustrates examples of components of the holder system 100, additional components can be added and existing components can be removed and/or modified.

As illustrated in FIG. 1 and FIG. 3 (side view), the holder system 100 includes a holder tube 102, an auger 104, and a handle 106. The holder tube 102 operates to hold a fishing rod and/or fishing pole when holder system 100 is secured into the material of the ground. The auger 104 and handle 106 operate in concert to assist with securing the holder system 100 within the material of the ground. The auger 104 includes an auger tip that assists with driving the holder system into the material of the ground. In some embodiments, the auger tip can be a spiral plate as described in further detail below. In some embodiments, the auger tip can be a mechanical screw.

The handle 106 extends from opposing sides of the holder tube 102 to provide a gripping point for a user. The handle 106 allows the holder system 100 to be twisted, thereby causing the auger tip to "bite" into the material of the ground, thereby providing a force to pull the auger into the material of the ground. In embodiments, the material of the ground can be any combination of materials through around the auger 104 can be secured. For example, the material of the ground can be sand. In another example, the material of the ground can be dirt.

As further illustrated in FIG. 2, which is an exploded view, the holder tube 102 can include a body 110 having a proximal end 112 and a distal end 114. The proximal end 112 can include a top opening 116 to a cavity 118 defined by the body 110. As illustrated, the body 110 can be constructed having a cylindrical shape, thereby defining a cylindrical shape for the cavity 118. The proximal end 112 of the body 110 can also include a notch 120 extending downward from the top opening 116. The proximal end 112 of the body 110 can also include a lip 126 that protrudes from the body 110. For example, the lip 126 can protrude outward and upward at an angle greater than 90 degrees. The body 110 also

includes a connection holes **122** and a connection hole **124** for holding the handle **106**, further described below.

In embodiments, the holder tube **102** can be construed of any type of durable material such as metal, metal alloy, synthetic polymer, natural material, composite metal, etc. For example, the holder tube **102** can be constructed of an aluminum alloy, e.g., 6061-T6 aluminum alloy (Unified Numbering System (UNS) designation A96061).

In operation, the holder tube **102** operates to hold a portion of a fishing rod and/or fishing pole. For example, an end and/or handle of a fishing rod and/or fishing pole can be inserted into the opening **116** into the cavity **118** of the body **110**. As such, the holder tube **102** can hold the fishing rod and/or fishing pole stationary during fishing. The lip **126** can assist in inserting the end and/or handle of the fishing rod and/or fishing pole into the opening **116** by providing a slanted surface that directs the end and/or handle into the opening **116**. The notch **120** can assist in removing/inserting the end and/or handle of the fishing rod and/or fishing pole.

The auger **104** includes an auger rod **130** having a proximal end **160** and a distal end **162**. The proximal end **160** of the auger rod **130** is coupled to the holder tube **102** via a connection device **132**, described below in further detail. The distal end **162** of the auger rod **130** can be tapered to a point to allow for easier insertion into the material of the ground. The auger **104** also includes an auger plate **134** coupled to the auger rod **130** adjacent to the distal end **162**. As described below in further detail, the auger plate **134** can be formed of wedge sections that form a spiral along auger rod **130**.

In embodiments, the auger rod **130** and/or auger plate **134** can be construed of any type of durable material such as metal, metal alloy, synthetic polymer, natural material, composite metal, etc. For example, the auger rod **130** and/or auger plate **134** can be constructed of an aluminum alloy, e.g., 6061-T6 aluminum alloy (UNS designation A96061).

The holder system **100** includes the connection device **132** for removably attaching the auger **104** to the holder tube **102**. As further illustrated in FIGS. 4A, the connection device **138** includes a proximal section **136** and a distal section **138**. The proximal section **136** has a cylindrical shape that fits within the distal end **114** of the body **110** of the holder tube **102**. The distal section **138** of the connection device **132** can have a frustoconical shape that tapers away from the proximal end **134**. In embodiments, the connection device **132** can be construed of any type of durable material such as metal, metal alloy, synthetic polymer, natural material, composite metal, etc. For example, the connection device **132** can be constructed of an aluminum alloy, e.g., 6061-T6 aluminum alloy (UNS designation A96061).

As illustrated in FIG. 4B, the connection device **132** can include a connection via **141** formed through the proximal section **136**. When the proximal section **136** is inserted into the body **110** of the holder tube **102**, the connection via **141** can be aligned with the connection holes **122** of the body **110**. The handle **106** can be removably inserted through the connection via **141** and the connection holes **122** thereby removably coupling the auger **104** to the holder tube **102**.

In embodiment, the handle **106** can be constructed as a cyclical bar and/or tube that includes a first section **154** and a second section **156**. The first section **154** can have a diameter that is less than the diameters of the connection via **141** and the connection holes **122** thereby allowing the first section **154** to be inserted. The second section **156** can have a diameter that is larger than the diameters of the connection via **141** and the connection holes **122**. As such, the handle **106** can be inserted until the second section **156** abuts the

body **110** of the holder tube **102**. In some embodiments, the handle **106** can be held within the connection via **141** and the connection holes **122** by friction and/or tension provided by the connection between the holder tube **102** and the connection device **132**. In embodiments, the handle **106** can be construed of any type of durable material such as metal, metal alloy, synthetic polymer, natural material, composite metal, etc. For example, the handle **106** can be constructed of an aluminum alloy, e.g., 6061-T6 aluminum alloy (UNS designation A96061).

In embodiments, the handle **106** can be construed of any type of durable material such as metal, metal alloy, synthetic polymer, natural material, composite metal, etc. For example, the handle **106** can be constructed of an aluminum alloy, e.g., 6061-T6 aluminum alloy (UNS designation A96061).

The connection device **132** can also include a connection hole **142** formed in an upper portion of the distal section **138**. The connection hole **142** can be aligned with the connection hole **124** to provide a connection point for a lanyard **142**. The lanyard **142** can be coupled to connection hole **124** and connection hole **142** by a bolt and/or screw **152** and washer **150**. The lanyard **142** can also be coupled to one end of the handle **106** by a bolt and/or screw **146**, a washer **144**, and a washer **148**. The lanyard **142** can be constructed of any flexible or semiflexible material such as nylon.

The connection device **132** includes a cavity **143** having a cylindrical shape for receiving the proximal end **160** of the auger rod **130**. In some embodiments, the auger rod **130** can be permanently affixed within the cavity **143**. In some embodiment, the auger rod **130** can be removably held within the cavity **143** by the bolt and/or screw **152** and/or friction.

As illustrated in FIGS. 5A-5C, the auger plate **134** can include a spiral disk **200** having a number of sections formed about a central hole of the spiral disk **200**. The spiral disk **200** is inserted over the auger rod **130** and affixed to the distal end **162** of the auger rod **130**. As illustrated in FIG. 5C, the spiral disk **200** can include a central wedge **218** that is in a plane perpendicular to the long axis of the holder system **100**. The spiral disk **200** can include a series of descending wedges **216**, **214**, **212**, and **210** that are angled toward the distal end **162** of the auger rod **130** (relative to the central wedge **218**). For example, the wedge **216** can be angled approximately 5 degrees downward relative to the central wedge **218**; the wedge **214** can be angled approximately 5 degrees downward relative to the central wedge **218**; the wedge **212** can be angled approximately 7 degrees downward relative to the central wedge **218**; and the wedge **214** can be angled approximately 15 degrees downward relative to the central wedge **218**. The spiral disk **200** can include a series of ascending wedges **222** and **224** that are angled toward the proximal end **160** of the auger rod **130** (relative to the central wedge **218**). For example, the wedge **222** can be angled approximately 5 degrees upward relative to the central wedge **218** and the wedge **224** can be angled approximately 3 degrees upward relative to the central wedge **218**. The angled wedges form a gap **204** between the wedge **210** and the wedge **224**. In some of the embodiments, one or more of the wedges may have different relative arch lengths, e.g., different surface areas.

As illustrated in FIGS. 1 and 3, when the handle **106** is inserted, the handle **106** protrudes from opposing sides of the holder tube **102** and is approximately perpendicular to a long axis of the holder system **100**, thereby forming a T shape. To install the holder system **100**, a user can force the distal end **162** of the auger rod **130** into the ground until the

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auger plate **134** abuts the ground. A user can rotate the holder system **100** about the long axis of the holder system **100** using the handle **106**. As the holder system **100** rotates, the auger plate **134** digs into the material of the ground, thereby providing a force to pull the auger into the material of the ground. The holder system **100** can be rotated until the auger reaches a desired depth.

As used in the description herein and throughout the claims that follow, “a”, “an”, and “the” include plural references unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. Also, as used in the description herein and throughout the claims that follow, the meaning of “in” includes “in” and “on” unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. While the above is a complete description of specific examples of the disclosure, additional examples are also possible. Thus, the above description should not be taken as limiting the scope of the disclosure which is defined by the appended claims along with their full scope of equivalents.

The foregoing disclosure encompasses multiple distinct examples with independent utility. While these examples have been disclosed in a particular form, the specific examples disclosed and illustrated above are not to be considered in a limiting sense as numerous variations are possible. The subject matter disclosed herein includes novel and non-obvious combinations and sub-combinations of the various elements, features, functions and/or properties disclosed above both explicitly and inherently. Where the disclosure or subsequently filed claims recite “a” element, “a first” element, or any such equivalent term, the disclosure or claims is to be understood to incorporate one or more such elements, neither requiring nor excluding two or more of such elements. As used herein regarding a list, “and” forms a group inclusive of all the listed elements. For example, an example described as including A, B, C, and D is an example that includes A, includes B, includes C, and also includes D. As used herein regarding a list, “or” forms a list of elements, any of which may be included. For example, an example described as including A, B, C, or D is an example that includes any of the elements A, B, C, and D. Unless otherwise stated, an example including a list of alternatively-inclusive elements does not preclude other examples that include various combinations of some or all of the alternatively-inclusive elements. An example described using a list of alternatively-inclusive elements includes at least one element of the listed elements. However, an example described using a list of alternatively-inclusive elements does not preclude another example that includes all of the listed elements. And, an example described using a list of alternatively-inclusive elements does not preclude another example that includes a combination of some of the listed elements. As used herein regarding a list, “and/or” forms a list of elements inclusive alone or in any combination. For example, an example described as including A, B, C, and/or D is an example that may include: A alone; A and B; A, B and C; A, B, C, and D; and so forth. The bounds of an “and/or” list are defined by the complete set of combinations and permutations for the list.

It should be understood, of course, that the foregoing relates to exemplary embodiments of the disclosure and that modifications can be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure as set forth in the following claims.

What is claimed is:

1. A device for holding a fishing rod or fishing pole, comprising:
 - a holder tube comprising:

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- a body defining a cavity for receiving one end of the fishing pole or fishing rod, and
 - an opening in the body at a proximal end of the holder tube;
 - an auger coupled to a distal end of the holder tube and comprising:
 - an auger bar, and
 - an auger plate configured to assist with securing the auger in a surface in response to rotating the auger, the auger plate comprising a plurality of disk wedges that form a spiral around the auger bar; and
 - a handle removably coupled to the holder tube and the auger, wherein the handle extends from opposing sides of the holder tube perpendicular to a long axis of the holder tube.
2. The device of claim 1, wherein the auger plate comprises:
 - a central wedge lying in a plane perpendicular to a long axis of the auger rod;
 - a plurality of descending wedges angled toward a distal end of the auger rod relative to the central wedge; and
 - a plurality of ascending wedges angle towards the proximal end of the auger rod.
 3. The device of claim 1, further comprising:
 - a connection device that couples the auger to the holder tube, the connection device comprising:
 - a proximal section configured to be inserted into the distal end of the holder tube, and
 - a distal section having a cavity for receiving a proximal end of the auger bar.
 4. The device of claim 3, wherein the proximal section has a cylindrical shape, and the distal section has a frustoconical shape.
 5. The device of claim 3, wherein the handle is inserted through the holder tube and the proximal section of the connection device.
 6. The device of claim 3, further comprising:
 - a lanyard coupled to the connection device at one end and coupled to the handle at a second end.
 7. The device of claim 1, wherein one or more of the holder tube, the auger, or the handle are constructed of an aluminum alloy.
 8. A device for holding a fishing rod or fishing pole, comprising:
 - a holder tube comprising:
 - a body defining a cavity for receiving one end of the fishing pole or fishing rod, and
 - an opening in the body at a proximal end of the holder tube;
 - an auger coupled to a distal end of the holder tube and comprising:
 - an auger bar, and
 - an auger plate configured to assist with securing the auger in a surface in response to rotating the auger;
 - a handle removably coupled to the holder tube and the auger, wherein the handle extends from opposing sides of the holder tube perpendicular to a long axis of the holder tube; and
 - a connection device that couples the auger to the holder tube, the connection device comprising:
 - a proximal section configured to be inserted into the distal end of the holder tube, and
 - a distal section having a cavity for receiving a proximal end of the auger bar, wherein the handle is inserted through the holder tube and the proximal section of the connection device.

9. The device of claim 8, wherein the auger plate comprises:

a plurality of disk wedges that form a spiral around the auger bar.

10. The device of claim 9, wherein the auger plate comprises:

a central wedge lying in a plane perpendicular to a long axis of the auger rod;

a plurality of descending wedges angled toward a distal end of the auger rod relative to the central wedge; and

a plurality of ascending wedges angle towards the proximal end of the auger rod.

11. The device of claim 8, wherein the proximal section has a cylindrical shape, and the distal section has a frusto-conical shape.

12. The device of claim 8, further comprising:

a lanyard coupled to the connection device at one end and coupled to the handle at a second end.

13. The device of claim 8, wherein one or more of the holder tube, the auger, or the handle are constructed of an aluminum alloy.

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